

Study in China

University experiences, study tips, and academic resources

CDISCOVERY

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How to Apply for the CSC Scholarship in 2026

The Chinese Government Scholarship (CSC) remains one of the most prestigious fully-funded scholarship programs for international students. In 2025, over 20,000 scholarships were awarded to students from 180+ countries. Here's a comprehensive guide to help you navigate the application process.

Step 1: Choose Your Program

Visit the CSC portal at

csc.edu.cn

and browse available programs. You can apply to up to 3 universities. Popular choices include Peking University, Tsinghua University, and Fudan University. Most programs accept applications between December and March.

Step 2: Prepare Documents

- * Notarized highest diploma (bachelor's, master's, or equivalent)
- * Academic transcripts (notarized copies)
- * A study plan or research proposal (800+ words for master's, 1500+ for PhD)
- * Two recommendation letters from professors
- * Physical examination record (within 6 months)
- * Passport copy (valid for 6+ months beyond enrollment)
- * HSK certificate (Level 4+ for Chinese-taught programs)
- * IELTS 6.0+ or TOEFL 80+ for English-taught programs

Step 3: Submit Online Application

Complete the online application on the CSC portal. Upload all required documents and select your preferred universities. The system allows you to track your application status

in real-time.

Step 4: University Review

Universities review applications from April to May. Shortlisted candidates may be invited

for online interviews. Results are typically announced by July.

What's Covered:

- * Full tuition waiver for the entire program duration

- * Free on-campus accommodation (or accommodation allowance of

¥1,000-1,500/month)

- * Monthly living stipend: ¥2,500 for undergraduates, ¥3,000 for master's, ¥3,500 for PhD

students

- * Comprehensive medical insurance

Sources: Sources: [China Scholarship Council](https://www.csc.edu.cn) • [China Scholarship Council](#)

<http://www.moe.gov.cn> target="_blank">Ministry of Education of China

Top 10 Universities for International Students in

China

China is home to some of Asia's highest-ranked universities. Based on QS World

University Rankings 2025 and international student enrollment data, here are the top 10

institutions for international students.

1. Peking University (北京大学)

-- Beijing

Ranked #14 globally, PKU hosts 4,000+ international students from 120+ countries.

Known for humanities, social sciences, and medicine. The campus features stunning

traditional Chinese architecture alongside modern facilities.

2. Tsinghua University (清华大学)

-- Beijing

Ranked #20 globally, Tsinghua is China's top engineering university with 3,500+ international students. Strong programs: engineering, computer science, architecture, and business.

3. Fudan University (复旦大学)

-- Shanghai

Ranked #39 globally, Fudan hosts 4,500+ international students. Located in Shanghai, it excels in journalism, medicine, economics, and management.

4. Shanghai Jiao Tong University (上海交通大学)

Ranked #45 globally, SJTU has 3,000+ international students. Known for engineering, AI, biomedical sciences, and the prestigious Antai College of Economics.

5. Zhejiang University (浙江大学)

-- Hangzhou

Ranked #44 globally, located in the scenic city of Hangzhou. 6,000+ international students. Strong in engineering, agriculture, and computer science.

6. Nanjing University (南京大学)

Ranked #120 globally. Known for astronomy, physics, chemistry, and earth sciences.

Beautiful Gulou campus with historic buildings.

7. University of Science and Technology of China (中国科学技术大学)

-- Hefei

Ranked #137 globally. China's top research university for physics, mathematics, and quantum computing.

8. Wuhan University (武汉大学)

Ranked #194 globally. Famous for its cherry blossom campus. Strong in law, remote sensing, and library science.

9. Tongji University (同济大学)

-- Shanghai

Ranked #216 globally. Leading university for architecture, civil engineering, urban planning, and automotive engineering.

10. Beijing Normal University (北京师范大学)

Ranked #262 globally. China's top education university with 2,800+ international students. Strong in education, Chinese language, and psychology.

Sources: Sources: <https://www.topuniversities.com> target="_blank">QS World Rankings 2025 • <https://www.jsj.edu.cn> target="_blank">Chinese Education Exchange Center

<https://www.jsj.edu.cn> target="_blank">Chinese Education Exchange Center

Cost of Living Guide for Students in China (2026)

Understanding the cost of living is essential for planning your studies in China. Here's a detailed breakdown by city tier.

Tier 1 Cities (Beijing, Shanghai, Guangzhou, Shenzhen)

* University dormitory: ¥600-1,500/month

* Shared apartment: ¥2,000-4,000/month per room

* Meals (campus canteen): ¥15-30/day

* Meals (off-campus): ¥40-80/day

* Metro/Bus: ¥200-400/month

* Mobile phone plan: ¥50-100/month

* Total monthly budget: ¥3,000-6,000

Tier 2 Cities (Chengdu, Hangzhou, Wuhan, Xi'an, Nanjing)

* University dormitory: ¥500-1,200/month

* Shared apartment: ¥1,200-2,500/month per room

* Meals (campus canteen): ¥10-25/day

* Meals (off-campus): ¥30-60/day

* Metro/Bus: ¥100-300/month

* Mobile phone plan: ¥30-80/month

* Total monthly budget: ¥2,000-4,500

Money-Saving Tips:

* Always eat at campus canteens -- subsidized and nutritious

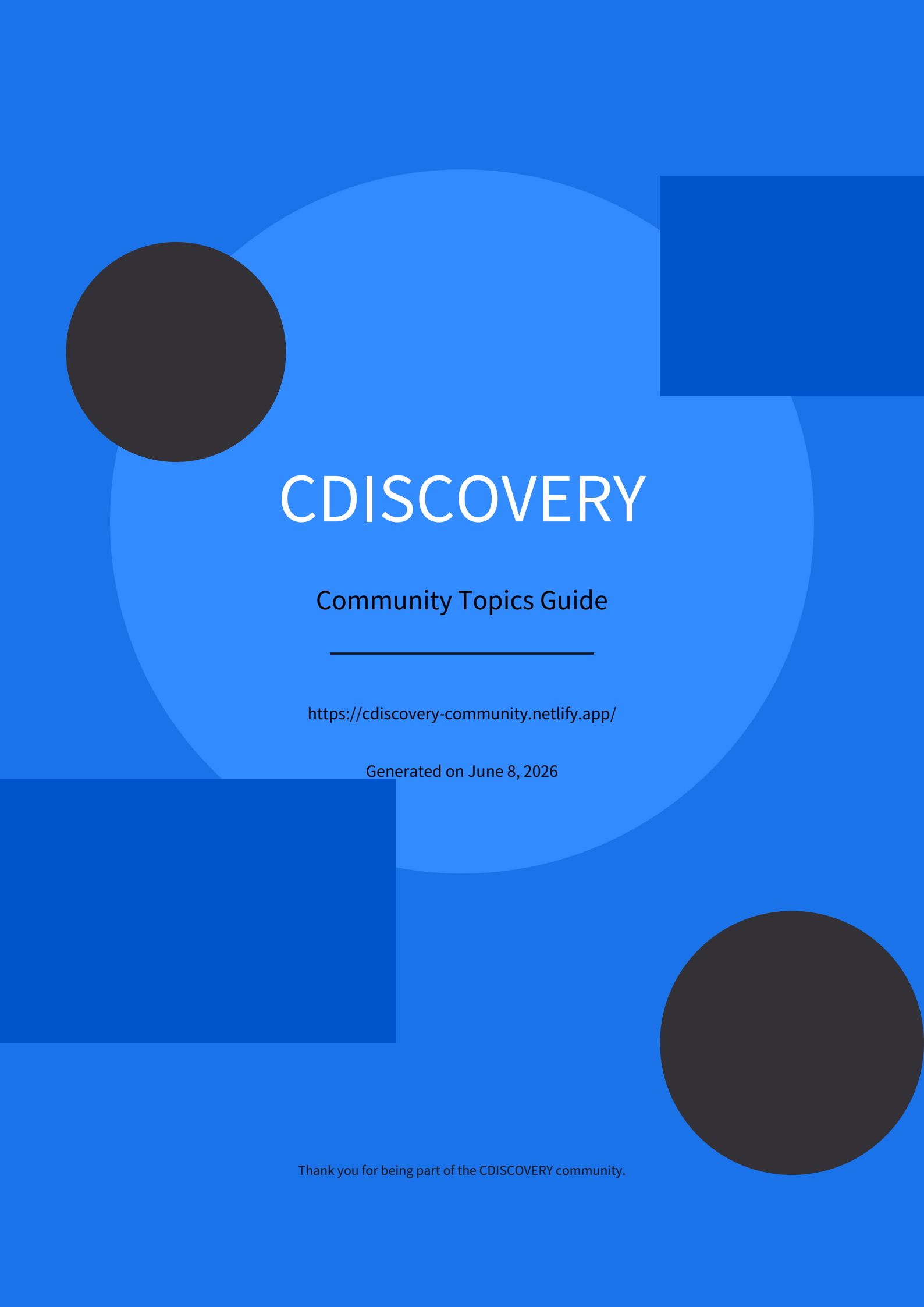
* Use student discounts on metro cards (50% off in many cities)

* Shop at local wet markets for groceries (30-50% cheaper than supermarkets)

* Use Taobao/Pinduoduo for online shopping deals

* Apply for university merit scholarships (¥3,000-10,000/year)

Sources: Sources: [Numbeo Cost of Living Index](https://www.numbeo.com) • [Ministry of Education](http://www.moe.gov.cn)

The background is a solid blue color. In the center, there is a large, light blue circle. To the left of this circle is a dark grey circle. To the right is a dark blue rectangle. Below the light blue circle is a dark blue rectangle. In the bottom right corner is a dark grey circle. The text "CDISCOVERY" is written in white, bold, sans-serif font across the center of the light blue circle. Below it, "Community Topics Guide" is written in a smaller, black, sans-serif font. A thin black horizontal line is below that. The URL "https://cdiscovery-community.netlify.app/" is in a smaller, black, sans-serif font. Below the URL, "Generated on June 8, 2026" is written in a very small, black, sans-serif font. At the bottom center, "Thank you for being part of the CDISCOVERY community." is written in a very small, black, sans-serif font.

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